Ans. (a) : Statement (1) : Core Banking Solution (CBS) is the networking of branches, which enables customers to operate their accounts and avail banking services from any branch of the Bank of CBS network, regardless of where customer maintains their account. So, (1) is correct.
Statement (2) and (3) : Unlike a regular bank, a payment bank can't loan money to people or issue credit cards. While the payment bank can't issue credit cards, they can issue ATM and debit cards.

48. What is/are the purpose/purposes of the 'Marginal Cost of Funds based Lending Rate (MCLR)' announced by RBI ?
[Marginal Cost of Funds based Lending Rate (MCLR)]'

1. These guidelines help improve the transparency in the methodology followed by banks for determining the interest rates on advances.
2. These guidelines help ensure availability of bank credit at interest rates which are fair to the borrowers as well as the banks.

Select the correct answer using the code given below

(a) 1 only (b) 2 only
(c) Both 1 and 2 (d) Neither 1 nor 2

Ans. (c): The Reserve Bank of India has brought a new methodology of setting lending rates by commercial banks under the name Marginal Cost of Funds based Lending Rate (MCLR). It has modified the existing base rate system from April 2016 onwards. As per the new guidelines by the RBI, banks have to prepare the Marginal Cost of Funds based Lending Rate (MCLR), which will be the internal benchmark lending rates. Based upon this MCLR interest rate for different types of customers should be fixed in accordance with their riskiness. The base rate will be now determined on the basis of the MCLR calculation. The MCLR should be revised monthly by considering a few factors, including the repo rate and other borrowing rates. Specifically the repo rate and other borrowing rates that were not explicitly considered under the base rate system.

• Foreign Trade and Economic Organization of India, Stock Exchange

49. Which of the following best described the term 'import cover', sometimes seen in the news ?

(a) It is the ratio of value of imports to the Gross Domestic product of a country
(b) It is the total value of imports of a country in a year
(c) It is the ratio between the value of exports and that of imports between two countries
(d) It is the number of months of imports that could be paid for by a country's international reserves.

Ans. (d): Import cover is an important indicator of the stability of the currency. It measures the number of months of money available in the national bank to cover the cost of imports or the stock of foreign exchange reserves in terms of months of retained imports of goods as at the end of the year. During the currency crisis of 2013, when foreign exchange reserves fell to around $ 275 billion, import cover dipped to around seven months.

50. India's ranking in the 'Ease of Doing Business Index' is sometimes seen in the news. Which of the following has declared that ranking ? (Ease of Doing Business Index)'

(a) Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development (OECD)
(b) World Economic Forum
(c) World Bank
(d) World Trade Organization (WTO)

Ans. (c): In World Banks' Ease of Doing Business Report, India's position has improved from 142 to 130. This is on account of the ease of starting a business dealing with construction permits and getting electricity permits. Now, companies can get connected to the grid and get on with their business 14 days sooner than before. The number of days taken to start a new business has gone up marginally from last year, from 28.4 to 29. Credit is one area where India performs poorly and needs to improve. Access to credit and ease of paying taxes has worsened, according to the World Bank's Doing Business Report 2016.

51. What is /are the purpose/ purposes of Government's ' Sovereign Gold Bond Scheme' and 'Gold Monetization Scheme' ?

1. To bring the idle gold lying with Indian households into the economy.
2. To promote FDI in the gold and Jewellery sector.
3. To reduce India's dependence on gold imports.

Select the correct answer using the code give below :

(a) 1 only (b) 2 and 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (c): The sovereign gold bond scheme was launched in November 2015 to reduce the demand for physical gold and shift a part of the domestic saving used for the purchase of gold into financial savings. Gold and crude oil have a significant role in India's widening current account deficit.

SCIENCE

• Medical Science, Biology

52. Which of the following statements is/are correct ?
Viruses can infect–

1. Bacteria
2. Fungi
3. Plants

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d): Viruses are known to infect almost any kind of host that has living cells. Animals, plants, fungi and bacteria are all subject to viral infection.
A bacteriophage is a virus that infects and replicates within a bacterium. Mycoviruses are viruses that infect fungi. A host of other viruses affect plants.

• Agriculture, Animal Husbandry and Dairy

53. Which of the following is /are the advantage/ advantages of practicing drip irrigation?

1. Reduction in weed
2. Reduction in soil salinity
3. Reduction in soil erosion

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 and 2 only
(b) 3 only
(c) 1 and 3 only
(d) None of the above is an advantage of practicing drip irrigation

Ans. (c): Drip irrigation is the application of small quantities of water directly into above and below the soil surface, usually as discrete drops as tiny streams with the help of emitters placed along a delivery line. It is also known as Micro-irrigation. The advantage/ advantages of practicing drip irrigation include reduction in weed, reduction in soil erosion, reduction in soil salinity is not the advantage of drip irrigation practices.

54. What is/are unique about 'Kharai camel' a breed found in India?

1. It is capable of swimming up to three kilometers in seawater
2. It survives by grazing on mangroves.
3. It lives in the wild and cannot be domesticated.

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (a): The Kharai camels are a unique breed of the camel found in Kutch of Gujarat and feed on mangroves on the island offshore. Hence, statement (2) is correct.

- The Kharai camels can swim up to three kilometres into the sea in search of mangroves, their primary food. Hence, statement (1) is correct.
- People consume their milk, while male calves are sold for economic returns. Hence it can be domesticated. Hence, statement (3) is incorrect.
- Given the breed's ability to survive both on land and sea, the Kharai camel is one of the most preferred choices of graziers in the arid coastal region of Kutch.

• Science & Technology

55. On which of the following can you find the Bureau of Energy Efficiency Star Label ?

1. Ceiling fans
2. Electric geysers
3. Tubular fluorescent lamps

Select the correct answer using the code given below :

(a) 1 and 2 only (b) 3 only
(c) 2 and 3 only (d) 1, 2 and 3

Ans. (d): The Bureau initiated the Standards for Labeling programme for equipment and appliances in 2006 to provide the consumer as an informed choice about the energy-saving and thereby the cost-saving potential of the relevant marketed product scheme is invoked for 21 equipment/ appliances, i.e., electric storage type geyser, ceiling fans Tubular Fluorescent Tube Lights, Frost Free Refrigerators, Distribution Transformers, Induction Motors, Direct, Cool Refrigerator, Color TVs, Agricultural, pumps sets, LPG stoves, washing machine, Laptops, Room air Conditioners, ballast, floor standing ACs, office automation products, Diesel Generating sets and Diesel pumpsets.

56. India is an important member of the 'International Thermonuclear Experimental Reactor'. If this experiment succeeds, what is the immediate advantages for India ?

(a) It can use thorium in place of uranium for power generation
(b) It can attain a global role in satellite navigation
(c) It can drastically improve the efficiency of its fission reactors in power generation
(d) It can build fusion reactors for power generation